

Voila!
Jazz snap
home court
win streak
of Magic

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Sports

White Sox arm themselves
with ex-Admiral King star
Page B3

Indians clobber Tigers
Page B3

Jerry Rombach, Sports editor, 329-7135

The Chronicle-Telegram

Wednesday, March 15, 1995 B1



DAN COUGHLIN

FIU coach from Ohio defies odds

It seems there's always a coach from Orrville in the NCAA basketball tournament, and this year is no exception.

Except that this year there are two of them.

As usual, the Indiana Hoosiers, coached by Orrville native Bobby Knight, are in the 64-team field. It's not in the NCAA by-laws that college basketball can't hold a tournament without Bobby Knight, although it seems that way.

But another Orrville native has a much more interesting story.

Bob Weltlich, who graduated from Orrville High School in Wayne County in 1963 and then from Ohio State in 1967 — five years after Knight — has Florida International in the big dance for the first time.

Just getting there was almost miraculous.

Weltlich, 50, had to quit his job to light a fire under the Golden Panthers, and it has grown into a blazing inferno.

Weltlich announced in January that he would step down at the end of the season, his fifth at FIU. The Golden Panthers had a 5-17 record at the time, and anybody who said they were headed for the NCAA tournament would have been branded a lunatic, even by the standards of Miami, where FIU is located. FIU, after all, a commuter school just west of downtown Miami with no reputation and no visible support from even the locals, has been a Division I program for only eight years.

But FIU won six of its last seven games and qualified for the tournament by winning its Trans-America Conference tournament. Its record of 11-18 is the worst in the NCAA tournament since 1961, when George Washington University qualified with a 9-16 mark.

The mere presence of FIU among the elite 64 elicited more than a few chuckles.

In USA Today, oddsmaker Danny Sheridan immediately made FIU a trillion-to-one long shot, the longest long shot in the history of the NCAA basketball tournament.

Naturally, no sports book in Nevada would actually pay off at such odds. A one dollar bet at a trillion-to-one would bankrupt them. The entire national debt is \$4.6 trillion. If Hillary Clinton, smart investor that she is, bet \$4,600 on FIU and the Golden Panthers won the NCAA, she could pay off the national debt and she would be the greatest heroine in the history of the United States. But there isn't that much money in the entire state of Nevada.

Forget paying off the national debt. FIU probably won't get past the first round, anyway.

As the 16th seed, FIU has the honor of playing No. 1 seed UCLA in the West Regional in

See COUGHLIN, B2

Price close to being ready

Bart Hubbuch
Knight-Ridder Newspapers

CLEVELAND — Mark Price's actions brought hope to the Cavaliers Tuesday. Gerald Wilkins' comments brought a smile.

The two veteran guards participated to varying degrees in an afternoon practice at Gund Arena, marking their first workouts with the Cavs since each was sidelined by a serious injury.



Price
Price, who has been out since Jan. 14 with a broken bone in his



right wrist, was cautiously optimistic about a return soon to the active roster, although he wouldn't commit to a date.

Wilkins, meanwhile, amused the Cavs after his brief workout — most of it shooting drills — by hinting he could be ready for the playoffs next month.

Wilkins has been unavailable since Oct. 18, when he ruptured his right Achilles' tendon in an exhibition game. He underwent surgery at the Cleveland Clinic three days later, and isn't scheduled to return until the start of next season.

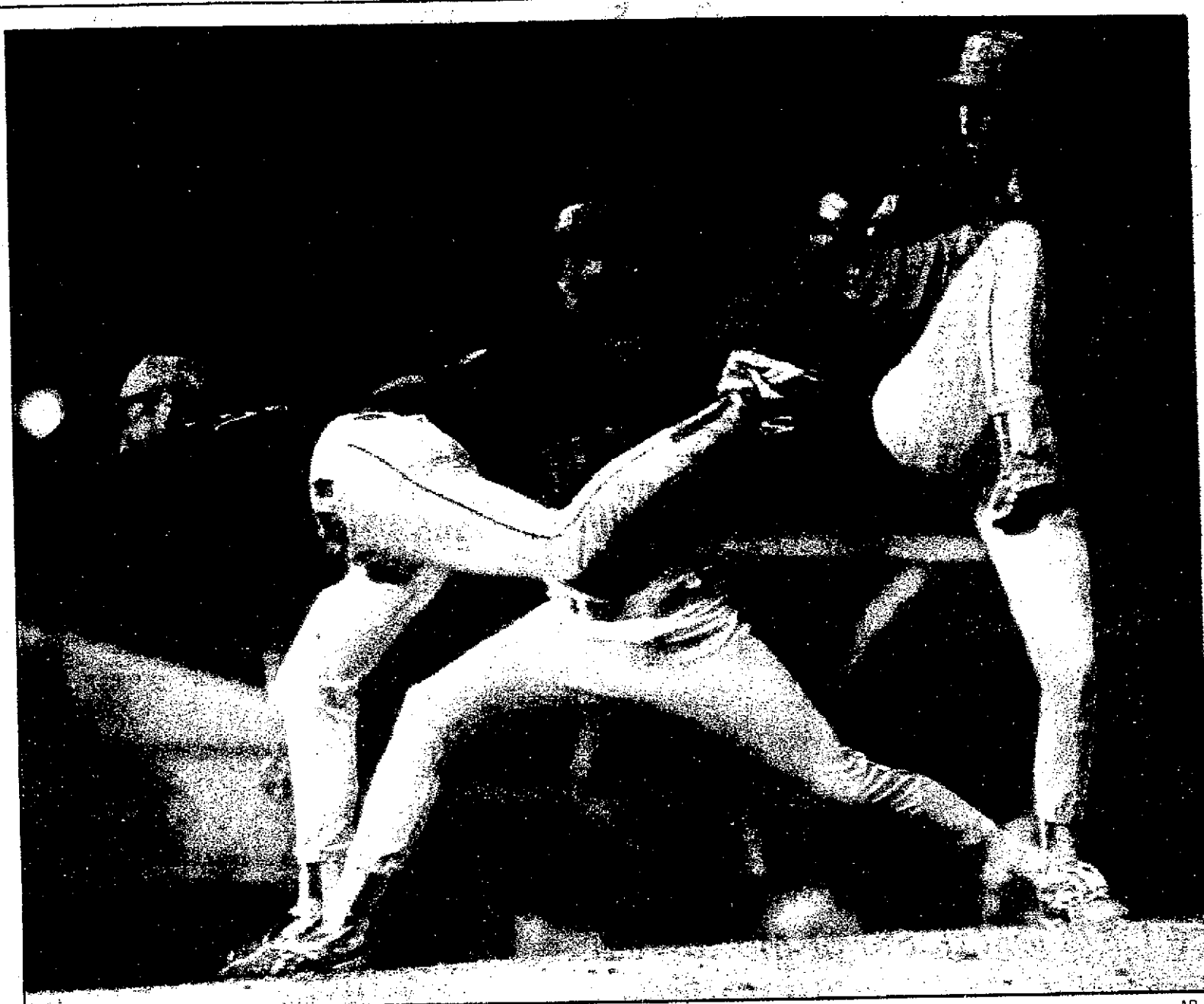
But with his six-month rehabilitation program set to end April 22, Wilkins tried to leave the door open for an early comeback.

"Right now, my goal is next season," he said. "But I'm a hard worker, and anything can happen between now and April 22. That's a long time."

Wilkins, who averaged 14.3 points and shot 40 percent from the 3-point line last season, didn't stop there, either.

"I can run now, and I've got about 75 percent of my calf strength back," he said. "It's just a matter of making the calf real strong. Once it's real strong, anything's possible."

See PRICE, B2



Out of body experience

Some tricky photography captures several sides of Texas Rangers

left-hander David Baine as he pitches against the Pittsburgh Pirates Tuesday in Port Charlotte, Fla.

AP

Behind in the count

Owners take another hit

WASHINGTON (AP) — Just 18 days before the start of the season, owners have another unfair labor practice charge hanging over them while both sides in the baseball strike wonder when talks will resume.

"The simple answer to why we don't have an agreement is that the owners haven't bargained in good faith," union head Donald Fehr said Tuesday after the National Labor Relations Board said it will issue an unfair labor practice complaint against the teams.

The NLRB accused owners of illegally eliminating salary arbitration and the anticollusion provisions of the expired collective bargaining agreement.

Fred Feinstein, the agency's general counsel, said he will decide within two weeks whether to ask the agency's five-member board for permission to seek a preliminary injunction in federal court to restore those rules. If a judge issues an injunction, players say they would end the seven-month strike, the longest work stoppage in the history of U.S. professional sports.

Owners, not wanting to play

See BASEBALL, B2

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

Lorain aims to slow pace against Euclid

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

It's taken Lorain High 72 years to get back to the round of 16 in the boys basketball tournament, so the Steelmen are trying to make the most of the opportunity.

Coach John Rositano's team is out to win, not just bask in the glory of the school's first district championship since 1923.

At this level, the challenges, naturally, are greater, starting tonight, when the Steelmen, 17-6, meet Euclid, 15-7, at 6:15 in

the Division I regional semifinals at Cleveland State's Convocation Center.

In the second game, Parma Valley Forge (13-11) tangles with twotime defending regional champion Cleveland Heights (22-1). The winners will meet for the championship Saturday at 7:30 to earn the trip to Columbus.

Lorain won a state basketball championship in 1923, the year the Ohio High School Athletic

See LORAIN, B4

Clyde ends Bulldogs' run

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO — Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue refused to alibi, even when offered the opportunity.

Donahue's Bulldogs battled Clyde to the wire in the Division II boys regional basketball tournament semifinals at Savage Hall Tuesday night, but the loss of two major weapons was too much to overcome.

Not only was Falls playing without Tim Matus, an 11-point scorer, who broke a leg in the final game of the regular season, but Tuesday the Bulldogs had to do without 16-point scorer Mark

CLYDE'S DEFENSE leaves Olmsted Falls coach on the defensive.
B4

Tabar most of the way.

With Matus out and Tabar in foul trouble the Bulldogs fell to Clyde 56-46.

"Matus is not an excuse," Olmsted's Donahue said. "We won three tournament games without him. They won tonight, we didn't. That's it. We didn't play very well, they did. We played the best we could."

Clyde, 20-5, will play Ottawa-Glandorf, winner over Sunbury Big Walnut in Tuesday's opener, on Friday night for the regional

championship and a berth in next week's state tournament in Columbus.

Tabar got into foul trouble in the first quarter, having two called against him on one possession. He sat out the entire second period, and was off the bench only six minutes in the last half before fouling out. He scored just three points.

Olmsted Falls also had horrible starts in both the first and fourth quarters go against it, but almost survived that adversity, too. The Bulldogs missed their first seven shots of the game, and the first six

See BULLDOGS, B4

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